

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

OPERATION MIDWAY BLITZ

Judge won't dismiss use-of-force suit

Citing Minn. shooting, presses pause on ending injunction on immigration agents

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A federal judge in Chicago on Thursday cited the fatal shooting of a U.S. citizen by an immigration agent in Minneapolis in declining to immediately dismiss a lawsuit that led to her landmark injunction limiting the use of force by immigration agents during Operation Midway Blitz.

In pressing the pause button,

U.S. District Judge Sara Ellis told the parties in court she still had concerns over her obligation to protect the class of journalists, clergy and other protesters certified in the lawsuit, noting “if I dismiss this case the preliminary injunction ceases to exist.”

“And it doesn’t give me much comfort in reading news reports that someone ... who was described as a legal observer was shot yesterday in Minneapolis,” Ellis told the

parties in an afternoon hearing. “So that is my concern.”

Ellis said that “given recent events,” she wants to do a little more digging on the law before making a final decision. She set the next hearing for Jan. 22.

After the hearing, lawyers for the plaintiffs said they had no concerns about the judge’s move, and said they were prepared to bring new litigation should there be a future surge in immigration enforcement here that violates the civil rights of citizens to observe and protest.

“We stand ready to do whatever is necessary to stop Presi-

IN CHICAGOLAND: Former Mayor Lori Lightfoot launches ICE Accountability Project to document immigration agents. **Page 3**

dent Trump, to stop (Department of Homeland Security Secretary) Kristi Noem, to stop (Border Patrol chief Gregory) Bovino, and their agents from violating the most sacred rights of the people of Chicago,” said Craig Futterman, an attorney for the Mandel Legal Aid Clinic.

Futterman also spoke emotionally about Wednesday’s fatal shoot-

ing of Renee Nicole Good, a mother who had been out recording immigration operations in Minneapolis when she was shot by an officer while seemingly trying to pull away in her vehicle.

He said the Trump administration’s claims that Good tried to run over the officer before he opened fire have been easily debunked only because “ordinary citizens had the courage to videotape what happened.”

A spokesperson for the Department of Homeland Security did

Turn to Lawsuit, Page 9



Demonstrators gather in protest of the immigration crackdown by Immigration and Customs Enforcement outside the Whipple Federal Building in Minneapolis, on Thursday. **JAMIE KELTER DAVIS/THE NEW YORK TIMES**

ICE killing fallout spreads

Minneapolis residents protest, state seeks inquiry role and schools close

By Rebecca Santana
and Tim Sullivan
Associated Press

MINNEAPOLIS — Minneapolis was on edge Thursday following the fatal shooting of a woman by a federal officer taking part in the Trump administration’s latest immigration crackdown, with protesters venting their outrage, the governor demanding that the state take part in the investigation and schools canceling classes as a precaution.

State and local officials demanded that the immigration

agents leave Minnesota after an Immigration and Customs Enforcement officer shot Renee Good, a 37-year-old mother of three, in the head while she was driving an SUV on Wednesday. But Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem said agents won’t be going anywhere.

The Department of Homeland Security has deployed more than 2,000 officers to the area in what it says is its largest immigration enforcement operation ever. Noem said more than 1,500 people have already been arrested.

According to documents obtained by The New York Times, the Trump administration will deploy more than 100 U.S. Customs and Border Protection agents and officers to Minnesota from operations in Chicago and New Orleans. The Department of Homeland Security declined to comment on the plans.

Dozens of protesters gathered Thursday outside of a federal building on the edge of Minneapolis that is serving as a major base for the immigration crackdown. They shouted “Go home, Nazis!” and other slogans as

Border Patrol officers pushed them back from the gate and used pepper spray and tear gas. “We should be horrified,” protester Shanta Hejmadi said. “We should be saddened that our government is waging war on our citizens. We should get out and say no. What else can we do?”

Gregory Bovino, a U.S. Customs and Border Patrol official who’s been the face of the crackdowns in other cities, walked along the long line of officers, looking at the crowd as protesters yelled at

Turn to Minnesota, Page 2

GOP’s Bailey defends immigration crackdown

Governor hopeful seeks to create space from some Trump positions

By Rick Pearson
and Jack O’Connor
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Darren Bailey, the two-time Republican candidate for governor who has ardently courted President Donald Trump’s support in past bids for office, sought Thursday to distance himself from Trump in the minds of voters while staunchly defending the president’s aggressive immigration enforcement tactics one day after a federal agent fatally shot a U.S. citizen in Minnesota.

Responding to a reporter’s question on the shooting death Wednesday of 37-year-old Renee Good in Minneapolis, Bailey said at a statehouse news conference in Springfield that “it breaks my heart when anyone loses their life.” But the GOP candidate for Illinois governor said the Trump administration’s federal intervention was due to Illinois and Minnesota sanctuary policies and because the Democratic governors of both states, JB Pritzker and Tim Walz, don’t uphold federal immigration laws.

“None of this should be happening if state government would be upholding the law. If we were doing this in Illinois, if they were doing it in Minnesota, the federal government would have no need to be there,” he said. Bailey added that he was “not familiar at all with the details” of the Minnesota shooting, videos of which ran counter to the federal Department of Homeland Security’s description of events, as has been the case in other immigration agent encounters.

“A life was lost and it shouldn’t have been lost,” Bailey said. “I feel like the federal government

Turn to Bailey, Page 2

Fan fever builds as Bears prepare for playoff game

By Robert McCoppin
and Talia Soglin
Chicago Tribune

Jenna Blazeovich can’t claim to be a die-hard Chicago Bears fan. She’s never been to a game. But when she’s working in her embroidery shop next to a bar called Christina’s Place in Albany Park, the roar from fans through the walls alert her to big plays.

Blazeovich does have a claim to fame related to the Bears, though. She was once invited by the Bears to embroider fans’ merchandise at the team’s draft party. Bears tight end Cole Kmet’s wife asked her to stitch his name and number into his jacket.

And her shop’s motto seems appropriate for Bears fans: “You can be thunderous.”

Blazeovich does a unique form of

IN CHICAGOLAND: A look back at memorable moments in previous Bears playoff runs. **Page 4**

IN CHICAGO SPORTS: What to watch for Saturday as the Bears-Packers rivalry is reignited



Packers at Bears
7 p.m. Saturday
Prime, Fox-32

chain stitching, similar to sewing, on an antique machine. She can write out any text requested, on the spot, on team hats, shirts and other paraphernalia. She also does work for the Cubs and other businesses.

“I’m always excited to see Chicago teams do well,” she said.

She’s not the only one. The

Turn to Game, Page 5



Chicago Bears fans Sidney Thompson, from left, Nate Hughes and Clarence Griggs tailgate before the game against the Green Bay Packers on Dec. 20 at Soldier Field. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

